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More envoys head to Tehran

Pakistan tries again for deal as US naval blockade continues

By **Samy Magdy, Sam Metz, Munir Ahmed and Mike Corder**
ASSOCIATED PRESS

CAIRO — Pakistan's army chief arrived Wednesday for talks in Tehran in the latest diplomatic move to ease tensions in the Middle East and arrange a second round of negotiations between the United States and Iran after almost seven weeks of war.

The White House said any further talks would likely take place in the Pakistani capital of Islamabad, though no decision had been made on whether to resume negotiations.

The U.S. naval blockade of Iranian ports continued for a third day. And a top official in President Donald Trump's administration warned of new economic sanctions on countries doing business with Iran, saying the Islamic Republic would feel the "financial equivalent" of a bombing campaign.

U.S. Central Command said Wednesday that no ships made it past the blockade in the first 48 hours, while nine merchant vessels complied with direction from U.S. forces to turn around and reenter Iranian waters.

But even as mediators worked for peace, tensions

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AIR ASSAULT: Israel pressed on with bombarding Lebanon on Wednesday, a day after historic talks between Lebanese and Israeli officials in Washington. **Nation & World, Page B4**

Garfield Park neighbors and elected officials mourn wife, son of former Cook County commissioner found dead in apparent murder-suicide



'Rooted in service'

By **Caroline Kubzansky, A.D. Quig, Sam Charles and Gregory Royal Pratt**
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Barbara Deer and her son Kaleb died in a murder-suicide, officials said, sending shockwaves through Chicago political circles as the city's West Side laments the losses in one of its most prominent families.

Their deaths were discovered late Tuesday after a family friend called police to the Deer home when Kaleb's twin brother, Kanaan, reported a notification on his Apple Watch that his mother had taken a hard fall. Late Wednesday, the Cook County Medical Examiner ruled the deaths of Barbara and Kaleb a homicide and suicide, respectively.

Karen Archer, front left, weeps while holding hands with the Rev. Shari Johnson as they lead a community walk in memory of their friend and neighbor, Barbara Deer, and her son Kaleb, in the 3500 block of West Arthington Street on Wednesday in Chicago's Garfield Park neighborhood.

JOHN J. KIM/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

The deaths came as a shock to the community. Earlier this week, Barbara Deer sent a message to a text chain inviting neighbors to go on a walk together. Friends and neighbors say that's who Barbara Deer was: an organizer who cared deeply about her community in Garfield Park, advocated for Juneteenth to be celebrated widely and doted on her three children and husband, Dennis, before he died in 2024, as they advocated for mental health care.

"Barbara Deer was a great person, a great wife, a great mother, (and a) great advocate for our community," lifelong West Sider Angela Sanders said outside the Deer family home Wednesday evening as two dozen community members

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CHICAGO CITY COUNCIL



Ald. Jessie Fuentes, 26th, speaks during a discussion on the One Fair Wage ordinance at the Chicago City Council meeting on Wednesday. **ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Wage hike survives veto fight

Outcome secures pay increases for employees who rely on tips, preserves key win for mayor

By **Jake Sheridan**
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

A City Council majority failed Wednesday to override Mayor Brandon Johnson's veto of their earlier measure freezing raises that are set to eliminate Chicago's subminimum wage for servers and other tipped workers.

Aldermen voted 30-19, short of the 34 needed to beat Johnson's veto and keep current wages in place going forward. The outcome instead secures ongoing annual pay increases for employees who rely on tips — and preserves, for now, a key victory for Johnson.

"Despite the efforts of corporate lobbyists, as leaders in Chicago,

we are not backing down from our commitments to workers in our city," Johnson said after the meeting. "Hardworking Chicagoans finally earning a guaranteed living wage is not the driver of increased prices. In fact, when workers are better compensated, they and their families are better able to put that money right back into our local economy."

The so-called One Fair Wage

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'OPEN FOR BUSINESS': Aldermen voted to make Ald. Gilbert Villegas chair of the City Council's powerful Zoning Committee on Wednesday, following a long-running stalemate that slowed development. **Page A5**

Guilty plea is feds' first conviction in blitz case

Suburban man struck Border Patrol vehicle

By **Jason Meisner**
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

A suburban Chicago man pleaded guilty Wednesday to a felony charge stemming from a traffic altercation with Border Patrol agents in Brighton Park in October, marking the first federal conviction involving the protests and unrest sparked by Operation Midway Blitz.

Anthony Gonzalez Alvarez, 27, of Lyons, entered his plea to one count of failing to report knowledge of a felony, which carries up to three years in federal prison.

In exchange for the guilty plea, prosecutors have agreed to recommend no prison time for Alvarez when he is sentenced July 22. However, U.S. District Judge LaShonda Hunt said she wants to wait to see the presen-

tencing report for Alvarez — who has a criminal record — before accepting the arrangement.

Either way, Alvarez is now the first person convicted out of some 32 people to face federal charges stemming from the Trump administration's two-month deportation campaign last fall, which sparked protests across the region and near-daily clashes between residents and immigration agents on the city's streets.

As of Wednesday, 20 of the defendants had been cleared, either through a grand jury refusing to indict, the dismissal of charges by prosecutors, or, in the one case that went to trial, a not guilty verdict by a jury. The U.S. attorney's office has entered into deferred prosecution agreements with three others that are on track to end without a criminal conviction.

Charges are pending against

See **GUILTY** on Page A2

CHICAGOLAND

Mayoral ally's CHA bid ends

The federal government on Wednesday officially declined to give former Ald. Walter Burnett a waiver in his longshot bid for the top job at the Chicago Housing Authority, the latest and perhaps final setback for Mayor Brandon Johnson's close political ally. **Page A3**

CHICAGOLAND

2 of ComEd Four walk free for now

Former ComEd CEO Anne Pramaggiore and longtime lobbyist Michael McClain were released from federal prison Wednesday, but their freedom comes with a future that remains uncertain. They will remain free on bond pending resolution of their case. **Page A6**

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